

Main Findings from the Survey

Executive Summary

In this section, we outline the main results of a two-language survey investigating how university students use AI tools in their academic activities, and the influence on students' interpretation of international politics events. The survey was administrated in two language versions (Turkish and English) with identical questions. A **total of 62 responses** were collected, including **28 Turkish** responses and **34 English** responses.

It appears that AI tools are widely used by students for academic purposes, since the **48.4%** of students use AI tools daily, while the **24.2%** uses them several times a week, thus being the **72.6%** of participants are actually using them on a regular basis. In contrast, despite this high frequency of use, it seems that there is an important gap concerning verification processes; in fact, the **71%** of students have already encountered false information from AI, while only 8.1% of students checks every single piece of information generated from AI; the other **79%** only check the information sometimes. The survey indicates also that AI is increasingly becoming an important tool in studying world politics since the **62.9%** of students admitted to have used the AI at least occasionally for better interpret the issues of the international politics, but students find it useful for understanding complicated things. However, students' open answers show important issues on misinformation, plagiarism and critical thinking degradation.

Overall, the student acknowledged the usability of AI but do not use it in a very careful or critical way. Based on these results, we developed the "Responsible AI Guide for Students".

Methodology

The questionnaire was developed using Google Forms and distributed online. There were two versions of the questionnaire (Turkish and English) which were used, making the survey accessible to a variety of students, thereby increasing the response rate for both Turkish students and international students.

The questionnaire contained three sections of questions:

- Questions about the respondents' demography (age, major and country of study)
- Multiple-choice questions, measuring the usage and perception of AI-tools.

- One open-ended question, asking the respondents to write down the greatest risks of using AI-tools for academic research.

The survey collected **62** responses in total. In total, **28** responses were received in Turkish and **34** responses were received in English.

Demographic Profile of Respondents

Demographics:

The results show that the respondents generally fall within the standard age range for students at a university. Over **50% (51.6%)** of the respondents are aged **21-23**. More respondents in the Turkish sample are in the **26+** age group, more students in the English sample are students at a Polish university.

About half of the respondents are students in various subjects not a specific field. The survey was intended for all students interested in world politics, yet only **12.9%** of the respondents said they are studying International Relations, compared to the 80.6% stating that they are studying something else.

This means that artificial intelligence tools are in use in many academic disciplines, not just political science or international relations.

AI Usage Frequency

The findings illustrate that the usage of AI tools is common in an academic context.

Across the whole data set:

- 48.4% use AI tools daily
- 24.2% use AI tools a few times per week
- 17.7% use AI tools sometimes
- 9.7% use AI tools rarely
- no participants do not use AI tools

These data show that the students are regularly interacting with AI tools within the academic context. Daily use at this high level can be interpreted that students see the tool as something that is there to aid them in a routine way such as summarising texts, explaining concepts or helping to write documents.

Use of AI for Understanding International Political Events

The questions were also asked as to whether they use AI to learn about international political events.

This showed that:

- 25.8% of students frequently use the tool for this task
- 37.1% of students use the tool sometimes
- 19.4% of students use the tool rarely
- 17.7% of students say that they never use the tool for learning about political events

This demonstrates that not only has AI become something to use to produce text, but also something to gather and understand information from and about the world.

Trust in AI-Generated Information

One additional question related to the trustfulness of AI tools: how much do you trust the information produced by an AI tool?

Based on the data from the survey:

- 14.5% trusted AI very much
- 72.6% trusted AI somewhat
- 11.3% did not trust AI much
- 1.6% did not trust AI at all

Most students are aware that the AI tool is not perfectly trustful, however the trust level seems to correlate to usage: they use it, although they know it's not 100% right, because it's more convenient to use than another information source.

Awareness of Incorrect or Misleading Information

One of the most important question: Have you ever noticed any incorrect or misleading information generated by an AI tool?

Based on the data from the survey:

- 71% noticed incorrect/misleading information
- 9.7% did not notice incorrect/misleading information
- 19.4% were not sure whether they noticed incorrect/misleading information

The fact that more than 70% of respondents has directly experienced wrong answers from AI tool emphasizes the problem as being more than just theoretical.

Verification Behaviour

Despite most of students knowing that AI tool generates errors, the behaviour in the usage does not reflect it. Asked about whether they ever verify any information generated by an AI tool using other sources:

- 8.1% said they always verified
- 79% said they sometimes verified
- 9.7% said they rarely verified
- 3.2% said they never verified

This finding shows the gap between the knowledge and actual behavior which is the core problem in this context.

Most Frequently Used AI Tools

The survey also questioned students on which type of AI tools they use the most.

There is a huge preference for chatbot type AI tools;

- 69.4% ChatGPT
- 24.2% Gemini
- 4.8% Other tools
- 1.6% Copilot
- None reported that they used Claude as their main AI tool.

The data suggests that the majority of teaching around AI tools should focus on generative chatbot AI tool because these are the most widely used AI tools among students.

Perceived Benefits of AI in Understanding Global Issues

Students were also asked about whether AI helps them to understand global political issues more.

The general views were positive:

- 45.2% Yes
- 45.2% Maybe
- 9.7% No

The data shows that majority of students sees AI as helpful to understand the complicated global political issues. However the above data on the misinformation and the verification gap points that the AI as helpful tool is accompanied with its responsible use.

Thematic Analysis of Open-Ended Responses

The open-ended question was asking students "what do you think is the greatest risk when using AI tools for your research?". 34 open-ended answers were coded using thematic analysis. Several themes came out from the coding.

1. Misinformation or incorrect answers

This was the most frequently highlighted issue. Students were concerned about receiving incorrect or misleading answers from AI. Sample of phrases: "AI can sometimes give wrong information", "Incorrect information can mislead students." Several respondents emphasized that AI responses can give misleading impressions of knowledge even when they lack accuracy.

2. Lack of source verification

Second issue highlighted was the lack of source verification using AI. Students were concerned about, fabricated or incorrect citations, lack of references, relying on summaries of academic sources instead of actual academic sources.

3. Academic integrity risks and plagiarism

Several students identified plagiarism and use of copy-pasted AI-generated texts in assignments as major concerns. Sample of phrases: "plagiarism", "copy-paste culture", "cheating".

4. Reduced ability of critical thinking

Some respondents worried that using too much of AI would negatively impact students ability to think critically or have original opinions. One respondent noted: "Heavy use of AI might undermine students' own independent critical thinking abilities".

5. Reduced engagement in research

One last theme that was identified in the response were the concerns about AI leading to shallower engagement in research. Some students might not take the effort to read academic sources and look for different perspectives and will only read an AI summarized text.

Interpretation of Key Findings

This is quite a paradox, because as one group of students is enjoying a whole range of AI tools as a means to fully comprehend topics, others are facing pitfalls with them, because it is easy to find information provided by AI that is wrong. Students perceive that there are risks in AI generated content.

However, the most salient issue derived from the survey is the verification gap. Although the risk of receiving and accepting wrong information is evident for many students, the habit of verifying information appears to be mostly absent. It depends more on motivation than on habits to check whether AI provided information is actually reliable.

It could be therefore that students require explicit direction on how to use AI in an academic setting in a more responsible way.

Implications for the Responsible AI Guide

The conclusions of this survey are very relevant for the creation of a Responsible AI Guide for Students. This guide would need to be focused on how to apply reliable methods to check the AI produced information, source checking and citations, maintaining academic integrity while using AI and how to use AI as a research assistant, but not as a source of truth that can substitute an active role in learning.

References

UNESCO (2023). Guidance for Generative AI in Education and Research.

OECD (2024). Facts Not Fakes: Tackling Disinformation and Strengthening Information Integrity.

Farquhar, S. et al. (2024). Detecting hallucinations in large language models using semantic entropy. Nature.